

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY

B.A. (Hons.) Semester IV Examination, 2025-26 (NEP)

DEPARTMENT OF PHILOSOPHY

Paper Code: PHIMJ-42 : Contemporary Western Philosophy

Time: 2:30 Hours

Max. Marks: 70

(Write your Roll No. at the top immediately on the receipt of this question paper)

Note: Attempt all the three Sections : A, B and C according to the instructions given.

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SECTION A / -

(Long Answer Type Questions /)

Note: Attempt any three questions out of the following five questions, in about 300 words each. Each question carries 10 marks.

300 10

Question 1. What are the main features of Jean-Paul Sartre's existentialism? Discuss.

- ? [10]

Question 2. Discuss Ludwig Wittgenstein's Picture Theory of Meaning.

[10]

Question 3. Discuss G. E. Moore's refutation of Idealism.

[10]

Question 4. Discuss the main features of Pragmatism.

[10]

Question 5. Discuss Gilbert Ryle's concept of "Category Mistake."

"_" [10]

SECTION B / -

(Short Answer Type Questions /)

Note: Attempt any four questions out of the following six questions, in about 150 words each. Each question carries 5 marks.

150 5

Question 6. Explain Husserl's method of reduction.

[5]

Question 7. Critically examine Wittgenstein's theory of Language Games.

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[5]

Question 8. Explain the practical nature of truth in the philosophy of William James.

[5]

Question 9. Critically examine the theory of constative and performative utterances.

[5]

Question 10. Describe the key features of Bertrand Russell's theory of Logical Atomism.

[5]

Question 11. Explain C. S. Pierce's theory of meaning.

[5]

SECTION C / -

(Very Short Answer Type Questions /)

Note: Answer all ten parts of the following Question No. 12 in not more than two sentences. Each part carries 2 marks.

12 2

Question 12.

(i) Name any two existentialist philosophers.

[2]

(ii) "Ghost in the Machine" is a criticism of which theory?

" " ?

[2]

(iii) Who is regarded as the founder of Pragmatism?

?

[2]

- (iv) Name the group of philosophers that developed Logical Positivism.
[2]
- (v) Which book of Ludwig Wittgenstein presents the Language Games theory?
- ? [2]
- (vi) Who wrote “How to Do Things with Words”?
“ ” ? [2]
- (vii) Which philosophical tradition does Bertrand Russell belong to?
? [2]
- (viii) G. E. Moore is best known for rejecting which philosophical theory?
? [2]
- (ix) What is the aim of Husserl’s philosophy?
? [2]
- (x) Is Russell a Logical Positivist?
? [2]